



Australia bans social media for kids under 16

Should India do the same?

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In a world first, Australia will introduce a law that will ban access to social media for children under the age of 16 years – with no exceptions whatsoever. The anti-social media legislation is backed by Australian PM Anthony Albanese and his government, with various reports calling this decision the strongest such measure proposed by any country till now to prevent access to social media websites like Instagram, Facebook,

X.com (formerly Twitter), TikTok, among others, by minors.

According to Reuters, earlier today at a press conference PM Albanese emphasised, “Social media is doing harm to our kids and I’m calling time on it.” This law is part of a multipronged attack on social media, where Australia is trying out age-filtering and verification systems to block children from viewing social media platforms. Without mincing any words, Albanese was crystal clear in his remarks

aimed at social media platforms. “The onus will be on social media platforms to demonstrate they are taking reasonable steps to prevent access, the onus won’t be on parents or young people,” said the Australian PM, according to Reuters. The move enjoys bipartisan support in the country, with the leading opposition party in Australia expressing support for the age-restricted social media ban for the benefit of children.

Social media is bad for young minds

During his press conference signalling the decisive move, Australian PM Albanese spoke about the potentially damaging effects of social media on children’s physical and mental health, with increased risk of harmful portrayal of body image issues among girls and spread of anti-women content targeting young boys. Growing cases of cyberbullying and exposure to inappropriate content is also one of the chief reasons behind Australia’s move to restrict social media for childrens with a strong legal framework. Australia’s being lauded for not being the world’s first country to dis-